

Court No. - 3

Case :- WRIT - C No. - 13875 of 2016

Petitioner :- Hanuman Prasad

Respondent :- State Of U.P. And 4 Others

Counsel for Petitioner :- Arti Raje

Counsel for Respondent :- C.S.C.,Mahboob Ahmad

Hon'ble Krishna Murari,J.

Hon'ble Vinod Kumar Misra,J.

Sri Mahboob Ahmad who has accepted notice on behalf of respondent nos.4 & 5 prays for and is granted a weeks' time to seek instructions in the matter.

Put up as fresh on 6.4.2016.

Till then no coercive action shall be taken against the petitioner.

Order Date :- 30.3.2016

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Hon'ble Krishna Murari,J.

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By means of this petition filed under Article 226 of the Constitution of India, the petitioner has challenged the recovery citation dated 08.03.2016 issued by the respondent no. 3.

On 30.03.2016, Sri Mahboob Alam, learned counsel for the respondent nos. 4 and 5 was granted time to seek instructions in the matter. Today he served a copy of the provisional assessment upon the learned counsel for the petitioner.

It is contended on behalf of the petitioner that since he did not receive the copy of the provisional assessment notice, as such he could not submit his reply and in absence whereof the respondent treated it to be final and issued recovery certificate. Learned counsel for the petitioner states that the petitioner will submit objection to the provisional assessment within two weeks from today. Learned counsel appearing for the petitioner has also invited the provisions contained under Clause 6.8(b)(1) of the U.P. Electricity Supply Code, 2005. The argument is that the respondent-corporation while issuing the provisional assessment notice was required to fix a date in the notice itself for hearing so that the consumer could appear before the authority concerned on the date so specified.

From the perusal of the provisional assessment order, it does not appear that any date was indicated in the notice for hearing in the matter and in such circumstances, the contention of the petitioner that notice itself was not in accordance with the requirement of law, appears to have substance.

This Court in ***Ashok Kumar and others Vs. State of U.P. and others, 2008(6) ADJ 660 (DB)*** from paras 56 to 64 has considered the provisions of the Electricity Supply Code 2005, to be followed in a case of theft of electricity for assessment.

In the present case, we find that provisional assessment notice does not give the basis on which petitioner was assessed to pay Rs.5,19,603/-. The notice also does not specify the date for hearing, which was required under the Code.

In view of the fact that notice for provisional assessment issued to the petitioner itself was not in accordance with law, we are of the

opinion that petitioner was not afforded adequate opportunity as provided in para 6.8(b) of U.P. Electricity Code, 2005.

Consequently, the writ petition is allowed. The impugned recovery citation dated 08.03.2016 is hereby quashed. The final assessment order shall be made within six weeks after considering petitioner's objection, giving reasons to meet the objections of petitioner in the light of observations made in **Ashok Kumar (supra)**.

Order Date :- 6.4.2016

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